

ICU Patient Tracker – Quick Start Guide

1. Understanding the main screen

The app is divided into two main areas.

Patient and task sidebar

The left side is the Patient and Task sidebar.

Use it to:

- Create a new patient.
- Create a new hospital day.
- Search and select patients.
- Switch between the patient list and task list.
- Open the Patient Popup or Rounds workspace.
- Create a backup.
- Change a patient's disposition.

The disposition buttons at the bottom move the selected patient into the appropriate census group:

- **Home:** Patient has been discharged.
- **IMC:** Patient has transferred out of the ICU.
- **Active:** Patient is currently in the ICU.
- **Death:** Patient is deceased.

Patients who leave the active ICU census are not automatically deleted. They remain available in disposition bins and can be found later by selecting **Show bins**, changing the status filter, or searching across all bins.

The **Menu** button contains additional patient and application actions, including rename, edit details, archive, readmit, backup, settings, and help.

Press **F1** at any time to see the complete list of commands and keyboard shortcuts.

2. Patient-level information

The upper-right portion of the app contains information that belongs to the patient as a whole rather than a particular hospital day.

This includes:

- Patient name and MRN
- Species
- Code status
- Current acuity
- One-line summary
- Running problem list

This information remains associated with the patient as you move between hospital days.

Use **Copy Name** or **Copy MRN** to place that value on the clipboard. After a successful copy, the app minimizes so you can paste the information into ezyVet, a radiology viewer, or another program.

3. The Day Workspace

The lower-right portion is the Day Workspace. Each hospital day has its own charting, SOAP note, scratch notes, diagnostics, devices, and tasks.

Use **New Day** when beginning a new ICU day. Continuing information—such as active devices, unresolved problems, and certain unfinished tasks—may carry forward, while the previous day remains preserved.

Use the day selector and arrow buttons above the tabs to move between hospital days. Always confirm that the correct patient and day are selected before entering information.

Daily tabs

The tabs appear in this order:

1. **[Chart]**
2. **[SOAP]**
3. **Sandbox**
4. **Problems**
5. **Diagnostics**
6. **Devices**
7. **Tasks**

Press **Ctrl+1** through **Ctrl+7** to open the corresponding tab. Use **Ctrl+Tab** and **Ctrl+Shift+Tab** to move forward and backward through the tabs.

[Chart]

Use Chart for structured daily information, including:

- Treatment changes
- Pertinent physical examination findings
- Diagnostic summary
- Daily assessment
- Patient acuity

Copy Chart copies the structured chart information for use elsewhere.

Refresh SOAP writes the current mapped Chart information into the appropriate sections of the SOAP note while preserving unrelated SOAP content, such as overnight entries and recommendations.

[SOAP]

The SOAP tab contains the complete note for the selected hospital day.

Some patient and day information is inserted automatically. Remaining `#INPUT#` markers identify sections that still need information.

While editing the SOAP:

- Press **Tab** to move to the next `#INPUT#`.
- Press **Shift+Tab** to move to the previous `#INPUT#`.
- Use **Refresh SOAP** from the Chart tab when structured information needs to be updated in the note.
- Review the complete note before copying it.

Click **Copy SOAP** to:

1. Save pending changes.
2. Copy the full SOAP note to the clipboard.
3. Mark the selected day as uploaded to the EMR.
4. Minimize the app when the default minimize-after-copy setting is enabled.

Paste the note into the EMR and verify that it transferred correctly.

Sandbox

Sandbox is free-text working space for the selected patient and hospital day.

Use it for:

- Temporary notes
- Plans developed during rounds
- Pasted information
- Checklists
- Items that are not yet ready for the formal SOAP note

Unchecked Markdown checklist items can be reviewed with **Preview checklist tasks**. The app shows what it found and asks for confirmation before creating tasks. Extracting tasks does not erase or rewrite the Sandbox.

The Sandbox can also be opened in the smaller Patient Popup.

Problems

The Problems tab provides a structured version of the patient's running problem list.

You can:

- Add or edit a problem.
- Add supporting details.
- Resolve or reopen a problem.
- Reorder the problem list.
- Remove a problem from the selected day forward.

Earlier hospital days remain unchanged when a problem is resolved or removed later.

Problems are reflected in the patient summary and can be projected into the SOAP note.

Diagnostics

Use Diagnostics to track diagnostic tests and their results for the selected hospital day.

Diagnostics can be:

- Entered as pending.
- Updated with results.
- Marked complete.
- Reopened if additional follow-up is needed.

- Omitted when a planned diagnostic will not be performed.

Pending diagnostics also appear on the Task Board and in reminder workflows.

Devices

Use Devices to record active lines, tubes, drains, and other instrumentation.

Common devices can be added using the checkboxes. The app may ask for applicable details such as size, location, or placement date.

Active devices carry forward to a new hospital day and are synchronized with the instrumentation section of the SOAP note. Uncheck or remove a device when it is no longer active.

Tasks

Use Tasks to record work that still needs to be completed.

Tasks may include:

- Clinical to-dos
- POCUS
- Pending diagnostics
- Housekeeping items
- Scheduled reminders

Tasks can be added, edited, completed, reopened, or deleted. Incomplete continuing tasks may carry forward to the next hospital day.

4. Task Board and reminders

The **Task Board** combines outstanding work across the active ICU census.

It separates work into areas such as:

- Pending Diagnostics
- To Do
- POCUS
- Housekeeping

You can complete or reopen work directly from the board. This is useful for reviewing the entire ICU rather than one patient at a time.

Tasks with reminder times can produce reminder notifications. The status bar shows whether reminders are currently due.

Open the Task Board with:

- **Ctrl+Alt+T**
 - **Ctrl+Shift+T**
 - **Alt+Shift+T** from another Windows application
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5. Patient Popup

The Patient Popup is a smaller window designed to remain visible beside ezyVet, imaging software, or other applications.

It provides quick access to the selected patient's:

- SOAP note
- Sandbox

You can:

- Move between active patients.
- Switch between SOAP and Sandbox.
- Use compact or full mode.
- Pin the popup so it remains on top.
- Save and return to the main app.

Open or close the Patient Popup with **Ctrl+P**.

Within the popup:

- **Ctrl+Shift+O**: Open SOAP mode.
 - **Ctrl+Shift+S**: Open Sandbox mode.
 - **Alt+M**: Switch between compact and full mode.
 - **Ctrl+P** or **Escape**: Save and return to the main app.
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6. Guided Rounds

The Rounds workspace provides a census-wide review workflow for day or overnight rounds.

It can help you:

- Review patients in order.
- Confirm one-liners, problems, tasks, diagnostics, and devices.
- Record timestamped notes.
- Create tasks or diagnostics from a rounds note.
- Add information to an existing problem.
- Schedule a recheck.
- Promote an overnight update into the SOAP note.

Open Rounds with **Ctrl+Alt+R** or the **Rounds** button.

Within Rounds:

- **Alt+Enter:** Mark the current patient reviewed and move to the next patient.
 - **Escape:** Return safely to the main workspace.
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7. Saving and data safety

The app automatically saves after you pause typing. The save indicator shows whether information is:

- Saved
- Waiting to save
- Saving
- Unable to save

Press **Ctrl+S** whenever you want to save immediately.

Create regular verified backups using:

- The **Backup** button in the sidebar.
- **Ctrl+Shift+B**
- Menu → **Create Backup**

Closing the main window normally hides the app in the Windows system tray rather than fully exiting it. Use **Exit** from the tray menu or press **Ctrl+Q** when you want to close the application completely.

Do not place the active database file inside OneDrive, Dropbox, Google Drive, or another synchronized folder. Use the application's backup and synchronization features instead.

8. Essential keyboard shortcuts

Action	Shortcut
Show or hide the app from anywhere	Shift+Alt+I
New patient	Ctrl+N
New hospital day	Ctrl+Shift+D or Alt+N
Save now	Ctrl+S
Find a patient	Ctrl+F
Previous active patient	Ctrl+Shift+J
Next active patient	Ctrl+Shift+L
Previous hospital day	Ctrl+Shift+I
Next hospital day	Ctrl+Shift+K
Open Patient Popup	Ctrl+P
Open Task Board	Ctrl+Alt+T or Ctrl+Shift+T
Open Task Board globally	Alt+Shift+T
Capture a diagnostic result globally	Alt+Shift+R
Add a to-do	Ctrl+T
Add a pending diagnostic	Ctrl+D
Switch between Chart and SOAP	Alt+S
Start or resume Rounds	Ctrl+Alt+R
Create a backup	Ctrl+Shift+B
Open Settings	Ctrl+,
Open the command palette	Ctrl+K
Show all shortcuts	F1
Exit the application	Ctrl+Q

9. Recommended first-time setup

Before using the app clinically:

1. Open **Menu** → **Settings**.
2. Enter your name and credentials under **SOAP daytime resident**.
3. Confirm whether the app should minimize after copying a SOAP note.
4. Choose your preferred theme and autosave timing.

5. Create a test patient.
6. Practice creating a hospital day and completing each tab.
7. Copy a test SOAP note into a non-production text window and check its formatting.
8. Create your first verified backup.
9. If synchronization is configured, confirm that the bottom status displays **Sync: Synced** before relying on another computer.